

Jonathan Palisoc, Ph.D.

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Dept. of Health Management & Policy | University of Michigan | Ann Arbor, MI 48109

Education

University of Michigan | Ann Arbor, MI
Ph.D., Health Services Organization & Policy (Economics Cognate), 2026

Dissertation: Administrative Architecture and Medicaid: Essays on Barriers, Burdens, and Bargaining

Research interests: Medicaid and Medicare policy, health care financing, managed care, uncompensated and charity care, high-need populations, payment and delivery reform, medical debt.

University of California, Berkeley | Berkeley, CA
Master of Public Policy (M.P.P.), 2018

California Polytechnic State University, San Luis Obispo | San Luis Obispo, CA
Bachelor of Science, Quantitative Economics, 2013

Research and Policy Publications

Publications in Peer-Reviewed Journals

Mueller L, Batlivala N, **Palisoc J**, Kim C, Ostrovsky A, Ong M, Favini N. A Novel Intervention for Medicaid Beneficiaries with Complex Needs. *Journal of General Internal Medicine*. 2026 Apr;41(5):1222-1228. Published online September 25, 2025. doi: 10.1007/s11606-025-09839-2.

Manuscripts Under Review

Palisoc J. Fear as a Barrier to Coverage: The Chilling Effect of the Public Charge Rule on Children's Medicaid Enrollment. Under review. Dissertation Paper 1 (Job Market Paper).

Palisoc J. Suspension vs. Termination: Medicaid Continuity Policies During Incarceration and Effects on Post-Release Coverage, Employment, and Mortality. Under review. Dissertation Paper 2. Former title: Suspended, Not Terminated: Medicaid Coverage Continuity Across the Prison Door.

Palisoc J. Strength in Numbers: Interstate Purchasing Pools and Medicaid Supplemental Rebate Capture. Under review. Dissertation Paper 3.

Hoffman GJ, **Palisoc J**. Medicare's Rural Floor Wage Index Adjustment: Implications for Health Equity. Under review.

Tipirneni R, **Palisoc J**. The Affordable Care Act's Role in Aging Disparities Before and After Medicare Eligibility. Under review.

Working Papers

Palisoc J. Federally Qualified Health Centers and County Uninsurance: An Association Analysis with Proper Shift-Share Inference.

Palisoc J. Procedural Disenrollment and Community Health Center Finances: A Descriptive Analysis. Working title.

Palisoc J. Removing the Gate: Medicaid Prior Authorization for Buprenorphine and Prescribing.

Palisoc J. Watching the Workers: Electronic Visit Verification and the Medicaid Home Care Market.

Palisoc J. Coverage Without Citizenship: California's Medi-Cal Adult Expansion at 1-138 vs. 1-200% FPL.

Palisoc J. Medicaid's Venture Capital Moment? A Screened Census of Medicaid-Oriented Digital Health Investment, 2011-2025.

Palisoc J. When the Office Closes: Administrative Infrastructure, the SSI-Medicaid Linkage, and Medicaid Coverage Among Disabled Adults.

Palisoc J. Section 1108's Long Shadow: Sixty Years of Capped Medicaid in the U.S. Territories, 1968-2024.

Palisoc J. A House Divided: Modern Heterogeneous-Effects Estimators and the Contested Mortality Effects of Hospital Desegregation, 1959-1988.

Palisoc J. Coverage by State Choice: Medicaid Expansions for Undocumented Immigrants and Insurance Coverage.

Palisoc J. Restoring Medicaid Eligibility for COFA Migrants: Early Evidence from ACS Coverage Data.

Palisoc J. Who Responds When Children's Medicaid Becomes Continuous? Heterogeneity by Parental Education in the Labor-Supply Response to Multi-Year Section 1115 Continuous-Eligibility Waivers.

Palisoc J. When Medi-Cal Recedes: Section 17000 and California's County Health Care Backstop.

Acknowledgments in Peer-Reviewed Publications

Jacobs PD, Hill SC, Monnet JN. Newly and Previously Eligible Medicaid Enrollees Differ, but Not in Health Care Expenditures. *Journal of Health Care for the Poor and Underserved*. August 1, 2024. doi: 10.1353/hpu.2024.a934299.

Blog Posts, Policy Briefs and Presentations in Other Media

Palisoc J. Medicaid Eligibility and Enrollment Bonanza; A Crash Course in Medicaid Financing. Out-of-Pocket Retreat. 2023, 2024.

Palisoc J. With ACA Subsidy Stoppage, What's Next for California Healthcare? *Berkeley Public Policy Journal*. October 19, 2017.

Palisoc J, Chen L. Obamacare Repeal Almost Certain, But Questions Remain. *Berkeley Public Policy Journal*. January 20, 2017.

Pending Research Support

Co-Investigator, with Richard Hirth, PI. *The Impact of PBM Spread-Pricing Bans on Medicaid Managed Care Pharmacy Spending*. Arnold Ventures invited full proposal, submitted June 26, 2026. Pending.

Responsibilities specified in the proposal: day-to-day study design, policy-taxonomy construction, analysis and dissemination.

Selected Grants, Honors and Awards

- Rackham Merit Fellow, University of Michigan, 2021-2026.
- Poverty Solutions Grant, University of Michigan, 2026.
- Martha & Ernest Hammel Grant Award, 2026.
- Winner, NAELA Foundation Medicaid Estate Recovery Research Competition, 2025.
- HSR Student Fellow, Institute for Healthcare Policy & Innovation, 2023-2024.
- Finalist, Michigan Health Policy Case Competition, 2022.
- Junior Service Fellow, Agency for Healthcare Research & Quality, 2022.
- Distinguished Service Award, U.S. Department of Health and Human Services, 2020.
- Young Leader Immersion Awardee, Filipino Young Leaders Program (FYLP), 2019.
- Outstanding Graduate Student Instructor (GSI) Award, UC Berkeley, 2017, 2018.
- Superior Success Award, California Legislature for Assembly Bill 85 (2013), 2015.
- DHCS Academy Leader Award, California Department of Health Care Services, 2014.
- Dean's List, California Polytechnic State University San Luis Obispo, 2011-2013.
- Eagle Scout, Boy Scouts of America, 2009.

Research Experience

Program Integrity Alliance | Remote

Research Fellow, Medicaid Program Integrity | 2026-Present

- Lead a 15-month Arnold Ventures-funded initiative examining state Medicaid program integrity at the intersection of data use, technology, and program administration.
- Conduct a national landscape review and stakeholder engagement with state Medicaid agencies and Medicaid Fraud Control Units; develop policy briefs, stakeholder maps, and a leading-practices dashboard.

NY Medicaid Fraud Task Force | Remote

Contractor | April 2026

- Built a public-data Medicaid fraud analytic workflow screening a 3,563-NPI New York provider cohort across home care/CDPAP, SADC, LHCSA/CHHA, NEMT, DME, and SNF-family service categories using provider-spending, NPPEs, sanctions, corporate, litigation, property, and web-footprint records.
- Produced ranked investigative referral packets, validation logs, red-team audit materials, reproducible workbooks, and methodology documentation to distinguish public-data review signals from findings requiring claims-level or subpoena-based verification.

Institute for Healthcare Policy & Innovation | Ann Arbor, MI

Doctoral Researcher | 2023-2025

- Head researcher, coder, and modeler for NIH R01 grant: The Affordable Care Act's Role in Aging Disparities Before and After Medicare.
- Utilized American Community Survey, Health and Retirement Study, and Current Population Survey to construct interrupted time-series and event-study triple-difference models; estimated causal effects of the ACA on health equity and coverage for the age 50-64 population.
- Head researcher for grant examining effects of Medicare's rural floor wage-index policy and switching between Medicare Advantage and traditional Medicare on persons with dementia.

Agency for Healthcare Research & Quality | Woodlawn, MD

Research Intern | 2023

- Conducted research for the Center for Financing, Access, and Cost Trends using the Medical Expenditure Panel Survey and National Health Interview Survey to examine differences in health status and health risk between Medicaid and Marketplace enrollees.

UC Berkeley Goldman School of Public Policy | Berkeley, CA

Research & Policy Consultant | 2017-2018

- CA County Spending Effects: Behavioral Health & Reducing Recidivism. Original research for the California Behavioral Health Directors' Association; analyzed spending-allocation effects on behavioral health outcomes, recidivism, and downstream costs.
- An Analysis of Community Outreach Methods and Their Effectiveness on CalEITC Claiming. Original research for the California Department of Community Services & Development; used county-reported data and regressions to determine the most effective outreach methods for the California Earned Income Tax Credit.

UC Berkeley Labor Center | Berkeley, CA

Graduate Student Researcher | 2017

- Led analysis and modeling for center publication on effects of Republican ACA repeal-and-replace health care proposals.
- Prepared Medi-Cal data and literature reviews for the California Legislature and public stakeholders.

University of California, San Francisco - Institute for Health Policy Studies | San Francisco, CA

Research Assistant | 2017

- Provided research assistance for A. Gaffney paper The Effect of Large-Scale Health Coverage Expansions in Wealthy Nations on Society-Wide Healthcare Utilization and J.G. Kahn paper Lowering Prescription Drug Costs in the US: Why Prices Are High and Potential Policy Interventions.
- Led research constructing a model projecting the effect of a U.S. transition to single-payer on household spending.

Cal Poly San Luis Obispo, Economics Department | San Luis Obispo, CA

Capstone Researcher | 2012-2013

- Lessons for the Affordable Care Act: Finding Difference-in-Differences from the Massachusetts Health Reform. Original research using difference-in-differences methodology with Massachusetts health reform to project effects of the ACA on health spending per capita, copays, and emergency-department utilization.

Related Professional Experience

California Health Benefits Review Program | Remote

Cost Lead | 2026-Present

- Serve as Medicaid and California health policy subject-matter expert for the FY 2026 legislative year; analyze the financial impact of proposed health insurance legislation for the California Legislature using a cost model to provide independent, data-driven cost estimates.

North Carolina Dept. of Health and Human Services | Remote

Senior Policy Advisor | 2025-Present

- Advise the Medicaid executive team, including the Chief Actuary and Medicaid Director, on H.R. 1 (OBBBA) implementation, provider taxes, state directed payments, Section 1115 waivers, regulatory-effect support, and impact modeling and evaluation.

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Consultant | 2024-Present

- Assisted in development and implementation of a major state's Medicaid Section 1115 waiver amendment.
- Developed strategies for state implementation of screening, enrollment, delivery, and tracking of Health-Related Social Needs services, and policy analysis for transition to a total-cost-of-care model (AHEAD).
- Developed modeling, policy response, and briefing material for the financial implications of proposed community-engagement requirements on providers.
- Advised on reform of a large state's pharmacy benefit for Medicaid, including pooling with other state public agencies, interstate Medicaid pools, and implementation of novel rebate-negotiating methods, a uniform preferred drug list, and formulary construction.

Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services | Woodlawn, MD

Ph.D. Intern | 2023

- Subject-matter expert on Medicaid financing; drafted Medicaid Section 1115 demonstration-amendment Special Terms and Conditions and evaluation designs for New York, California, and Massachusetts, totaling more than \$10 billion in federal funds.
- Drafted new substance-use-disorder and mental-health-disorder monitoring guidelines for states.

U.S. Department of Health and Human Services, Office of the Secretary | Washington, DC

Medicaid Policy & Budget Analyst - Assistant Secretary for Financial Resources | 2019-2021

- Headed the Medicaid financing portfolio, coordinating HHS analysis on Medicaid managed care, telehealth, DSH, state financing, territories and tribal financing, Section 1115 waivers, drug pricing and rebates, Medicaid apportionment, and baseline.
- Personally wrote waiver updates, analysis, and tracking for the HHS Secretary's daily briefing book.
- Coordinated the budget process from policy formulation at CMS to OMB/White House submission, including congressional justifications.
- Represented the Assistant Secretary and Office of Budget for all comments and revisions to Medicaid proposed and final regulations, Section 1115 waiver applications, CMMI models, budget scoring, draft legislation, and guidance including State Medicaid Director Letters.

Center for Medicare and Medicaid Innovation | Woodlawn, MD

Economist | 2019

- Designed and conducted studies on economic issues related to CMMI models, including the Oncology Care Model, Comprehensive Care for Joint Replacement Model, Medicaid Maternal Mortality Model, and Bundled Payments.
- Personally wrote the initial Innovation Center Investment Proposal for the Transforming Maternal Health model.
- Designated by leadership as the bridge between executive policy and research/evaluation teams; distilled academic research into actionable insights.

- Analyzed claims, Part D, and expenditure data from major CMS data warehouses to inform policy decisions and model development.

California Association of Public Hospitals & Health Systems | Oakland, CA

Senior Policy & Finance Analyst | 2018-2019

- Developed policy, financial, and operational initiatives for all 22 of California's public safety-net systems; executed legislative initiatives and built relationships with California state leadership and health executives.
- Led big data team: encounter data and Medicaid/Medicare cost-report analysis, regulatory analysis of Medicare and Medicaid payment policy, 340B drug policy, and research on Medicaid incentive-payment and value-based models.

Office of Assemblymember David Chiu, 17th District | Sacramento, CA

Consultant for the Select Committee on Health Reform | 2017

- Advised Assemblymember Chiu on policy matters; drafted and advanced a package of 13 reform bills, including drug-pricing legislation.
- Led meetings with legislators and stakeholders; presented original material to advance health reform.

Kaiser Permanente | Oakland, CA

Master's Intern, Health Policy | 2017

- Served under Kaiser Permanente's Government Relations team, assisting in advocacy for commercial and Medicare cost controls, fair Medicare Advantage regulations, and Medicare Advantage reimbursement.
- Stretch project: Emerging Health Risk Trends for the Millennial Generation and Gen X.

California Department of Health Care Services | Sacramento, CA

Health Program Specialist - Office of the Director | 2013-2016

- Sole direct report to the California Medicaid Director and her Deputy Director team; managed and coordinated multiple high-priority projects across competing deadlines.
- Led discussions with the California Legislature, CMS leadership, CFOs of county hospital systems, county executives, and consulting entities.
- Led policy and financial analysis of California's Section 1115 waiver; developed and oversaw budget-neutrality calculations.
- Crafted data analyses and position papers for legislative and CMS negotiations on the MCO tax, hepatitis C drug spending, and coverage expansion.
- Coordinated the Department's 32 divisions on CMS Medicaid managed-care regulations, drug-inflation-rebate legislation, the FQHC payment-reform pilot, and capitated-rate and delivery-system incentive-payment innovation.

Teaching Experience

Oakland University, School of Health Sciences | Rochester, MI

Lecturer - PH 5700: Health Policy and Management | 2023-2026

Medicaid, Actually | Remote

Creator & Instructor - Original Medicaid policy, financing, and operations course | 2025-Present

University of Michigan, Ross School of Business | Ann Arbor, MI

Teaching Assistant - BE 708: Health Care Markets & Public Policy | 2023-2026

University of Michigan, Ross School of Business | Ann Arbor, MI

Teaching Assistant - BE 562: Growth and Stabilization in the Macroeconomy | 2023-2025

University of Michigan, Ross School of Business | Ann Arbor, MI

Teaching Assistant - BE 688: Health Policy & Politics Residential in DC | 2023, 2025

U.S. Department of Health and Human Services | Washington, DC

Instructor - Data Analysis and Visualization in Excel | 2020

University of California, Department of Political Economy | Berkeley, CA

Teaching Assistant - IAS 106: Intermediate Microeconomic Theory | 2016-2018

University of California, Department of Political Economy | Berkeley, CA

Teaching Assistant - IAS 107: Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory | 2016-2018

Presentations and Talks

- Paper Presentation: Strength in Numbers: Interstate Purchasing Pools and Medicaid Supplemental Rebate Capture. ASHEcon Annual Conference, 2026.
- Paper Presentation: From Pregnancy Care to Chronic Care: Multi-Drug Evidence on Medicaid's 12-Month Postpartum Extension. AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting, 2026.
- Paper Presentation: Effects of Medicaid Managed Care Competition on Quality, Spending, and Outcomes. Cato Health Policy Workshop, 2025.
- Paper Presentation: Fear as a Barrier to Coverage - Public Charge Chilling Effects. APPAM Annual Conference, 2025.
- Paper Presentation: Fear as a Barrier to Coverage - Public Charge Chilling Effects. ASHEcon Annual Conference, 2025.
- Discussant: Mortality and Immigration Enforcement: The Case of Secure Communities. ASHEcon Annual Conference, 2025.
- Panel Chair: Experimenting with Medicaid: Updates from Recent Section 1115 Waivers. AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting, 2024.
- Discussant: Characteristics of Patients, Providers, and Managed Care Organizations Participating in Four Medicaid Value-Based Payment Programs. Lewis AJ. AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting, 2024.
- Panel Chair: Achieving Payer-FQHC Partnership Success in the Value-Based Environment. Yuvo Health, 2022.

Service and Affiliations

- Abstract Reviewer, AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting - Medicaid, Coverage & Access, 2022-2025.
- Abstract Reviewer, ASHEcon Annual Conference, 2023-2025.
- Ad-hoc Peer Reviewer, 2025-2026.
- Director & Executive Board Member, Society of Health Policy Young Professionals, 2019-2022.
- Medical Debt and Charity Care Negotiation Volunteer, DollarFor.
- Inaugural Member, Out-of-Pocket Society.
- President, UC Berkeley Health Policy Club, 2016-2018.
- Manuscript Reviewer, Michigan Undergraduate Journal of Public Health, 2022-2024.
- Staff Writer, Berkeley Public Policy Journal, 2016-2018.
- Member, American Society of Health Economists; AcademyHealth; Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management.

References

Andrew M. Ryan, Ph.D.

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Dept. of Health Management & Policy, University of Michigan
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